

HIGHER SECONDARY SECOND YEAR (H.S. 2nd Year)
POLITICAL SCIENCE – 2024 (Code: 34T POSC)

Solved Question Paper (Guide)

Full Marks: 80 (Part-A 40 + Part-B 40) | Old Course: 100 (with Part-C 20) | Time: 3 Hours

Note: As this is a guide, all questions are solved, including every 'OR' / 'Any ____' question.

PART – A : Contemporary World Politics

Q.1 Answer any six (1 mark each)

(a) When did India do economic reforms?

Ans: In 1991.

(b) Name of the common currency of the European Union?

Ans: Euro (€).

(c) Write any one threat to human security.

Ans: Terrorism (other threats: epidemics, poverty, hunger, human rights violations).

(d) Full form of SAARC?

Ans: South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation.

(e) Which day is celebrated as World Environment Day?

Ans: 5th June.

(f) Which Earth Summit made environment an important issue in world politics?

Ans: The Rio Earth Summit (United Nations Conference on Environment and Development), 1992, held at Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.

(g) When was the ASEAN Regional Forum established?

Ans: In 1994.

(h) How many countries signed the UN Charter when it was formed?

Ans: 51 countries (original members).

(i) When was the UNO established?

Ans: On 24th October 1945.

(j) China adopted an 'Open Door Policy'. Yes or No.

Ans: Yes. China adopted the Open Door Policy in 1978 under Deng Xiaoping.

Q.2 Answer any five (2 marks each)

Q.2(a) Who was the first Secretary-General of U.N.O.? Where is the Head-quarters of U.N.O.?

Ans:

The first Secretary-General of the UNO was Trygve Lie of Norway (1946–1952). The Headquarters of the UNO is located in New York, USA.

[OR] Q.2(a) Name two NGOs concerned with the protection of human rights all over the world.

Ans:

Two NGOs working for human rights are:

- Amnesty International
- Human Rights Watch

Q.2(b) Write two differences between migrants and refugees.

Ans:

- Migrants leave their country voluntarily, mainly for better jobs, education or living conditions; refugees are forced to flee due to war, persecution, violence or natural disaster.
- Migrants can return home and still enjoy the protection of their own government; refugees cannot return safely and need international protection (e.g., UNHCR).

Q.2(c) Which two countries signed the Farakka Treaty?

Ans:

India and Bangladesh signed the Farakka (Ganga Water Sharing) Treaty in 1996 (12 December 1996).

Q.2(d) What do you mean by environmental awareness?

Ans:

Environmental awareness means understanding the importance of the natural environment and the problems affecting it, such as pollution, deforestation and global warming, and taking steps to protect and conserve it for present and future generations.

Q.2(e) Name any two member-states of ASEAN.

Ans:

Indonesia and Thailand (others: Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore, Vietnam).

Q.2(f) Write the names of two countries which emerged after Soviet disintegration.

Ans:

Russia and Ukraine (others: Kazakhstan, Georgia, Latvia, Estonia, Uzbekistan etc.).

[OR] Q.2(f) What is meant by Second World?

Ans:

The term 'Second World' refers to the communist/socialist countries of Eastern Europe led by the Soviet Union (USSR) during the Cold War period, which formed the Eastern bloc against the capitalist 'First World' led by the USA.

Q.3 Answer any three (4 marks each)

Q.3(a) Discuss the effects of globalisation in underdeveloped nations.

Ans:

Globalisation means the growing economic, political and cultural integration of the world. Its effects on underdeveloped (developing) nations are both positive and negative.

Positive effects:

- Inflow of foreign capital and investment, and transfer of modern technology.
- Growth of trade, industries and employment opportunities; access to world markets.
- Improvement in communication, education and information.

Negative effects:

- Increase in the gap between rich and poor; benefits mostly go to the elite and urban people.
- Local industries and small producers suffer due to competition from multinational companies (MNCs).
- Dependence on developed countries and loss of economic sovereignty to bodies like WTO, IMF and World Bank.
- Cultural erosion due to the spread of Western culture (cultural homogenisation) and environmental damage.

Thus, globalisation has given both opportunities and challenges to underdeveloped nations.

Q.3(b) What is meant by 'Global Commons'? Suggest two steps for protection of Global Commons.

Ans:

Global Commons are those resources and areas which do not belong to any single nation but are shared by all of humanity, e.g., the earth's atmosphere, Antarctica, the ocean floor and outer space.

Two steps for protection:

- Countries must sign and follow international agreements and treaties, such as the Antarctic Treaty (1959), the Montreal Protocol (1987) on ozone and the Kyoto Protocol (1997) on greenhouse gases.
- Common but differentiated responsibility: developed countries should reduce pollution and give financial and technological help to developing countries, and all nations should spread awareness and use clean energy.

[OR] Q.3(b) Discuss the causes of environmental pollution.

Ans:

Environmental pollution is the contamination of air, water and soil by harmful substances. Its main causes are:

- Industrialisation: factories release smoke, toxic gases and chemical waste into air and water.
- Rapid population growth and urbanisation, producing huge waste and sewage.
- Excessive use of vehicles and fossil fuels (petrol, diesel, coal) causing air pollution and global warming.
- Deforestation, which reduces the earth's capacity to absorb carbon dioxide.
- Use of chemical fertilisers and pesticides in agriculture, which pollutes soil and water.
- Plastic waste, nuclear tests/accidents and lack of public awareness.

Q.3(c) What are the functions of the Security Council?

Ans:

The Security Council is the most powerful organ of the UN, with 15 members (5 permanent with veto power and 10 non-permanent). Its main functions are:

- To maintain international peace and security.
- To settle international disputes peacefully through negotiation, mediation and arbitration.
- To impose economic sanctions or take military action against an aggressor, and to send UN peacekeeping forces.
- To recommend the admission of new members and the appointment of the Secretary-General to the General Assembly.
- To elect (along with the General Assembly) the judges of the International Court of Justice, and to recommend amendments to the Charter.

Q.3(d) Explain the causes for the disintegration of the Soviet Union.

Ans:

The USSR disintegrated in December 1991. Main causes:

- Economic stagnation: the centralised planned economy was inefficient; shortage of consumer goods and heavy spending on arms and the military.
- Political and administrative weaknesses: the Communist Party was authoritarian, corrupt and out of touch with the people; lack of democracy and freedom.

- Rise of nationalism in republics such as the Baltic states, Ukraine and Georgia demanding independence.
- Gorbachev's reforms of Glasnost (openness) and Perestroika (restructuring) increased demands for freedom and weakened the party's control.
- The Afghan war, the arms race with the USA and the fall of the Berlin Wall (1989) hastened the collapse; Boris Yeltsin's role also was important.

Q.3(e) Discuss briefly the components of the security strategy of India.

Ans:

India's security strategy has four main components:

- Strengthening military capacity: India faces threats from neighbours, so it built a strong army; it conducted nuclear tests in 1974 and 1998 for deterrence.
- Strengthening international norms and institutions: India supports the UN, disarmament, the Non-Aligned Movement and Asian solidarity to protect its security.
- Meeting internal security challenges: dealing with insurgency and militancy in areas like Nagaland, Mizoram, Kashmir and the North-East through political and security measures.
- Developing the economy: strengthening the economy to remove poverty and inequality so that national security is ensured.

Q.4 Answer any two (6 marks each)

Q.4(a) Discuss the importance and relevance of SAARC.

Ans:

SAARC (South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation) was founded on 8 December 1985 at Dhaka. Its members are India, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, Sri Lanka, the Maldives and Afghanistan (joined 2007). Its Secretariat is at Kathmandu.

Importance:

- It promotes economic, social, cultural and technical cooperation among South Asian countries.
- It aims to improve the welfare and quality of life of the people of the region and to reduce poverty.
- It provides a common platform for discussion and builds mutual trust and friendship among members.
- SAFTA (South Asian Free Trade Agreement, 2004) was signed to increase trade and reduce tariffs.

Relevance:

- South Asia has a huge population and common problems like poverty, terrorism, illiteracy and natural disasters, which need joint efforts.
- Cooperation in energy, connectivity, health and disaster management is very necessary today.

However, SAARC's progress has been limited because of India–Pakistan tensions, mutual distrust and lack of political will. Still, it remains relevant for regional peace and development.

[OR] Q.4(a) Write a note on India–Pakistan relationship.

Ans:

India and Pakistan became independent in 1947 after the Partition, and their relations have been full of conflict and mistrust.

Major issues:

- Kashmir dispute: the main cause of tension since 1947; both claim Kashmir.

- Wars: 1947–48, 1965, 1971 (leading to the creation of Bangladesh) and the Kargil conflict of 1999.
- Cross-border terrorism, which Pakistan is accused of supporting, and issues like Siachen and Sir Creek.
- Sharing of river waters, solved partially by the Indus Water Treaty (1960).

Efforts for peace:

- Tashkent Agreement (1966), Simla Agreement (1972), Lahore Declaration (1999), bus and train services and trade/cultural exchanges.

Both countries are nuclear powers, so peace between them is essential for the stability of South Asia.

Q.4(b) What are the main pillars of ASEAN? Discuss elaborately.

Ans:

ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations) was established on 8 August 1967 by the Bangkok Declaration. Founding members were Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore and Thailand; later Brunei, Vietnam, Laos, Myanmar and Cambodia joined (10 members). Its motto is 'One Vision, One Identity, One Community'. Its Secretariat is in Jakarta. ASEAN has three main pillars:

1. ASEAN Security Community (ASC):

It aims at peaceful settlement of disputes, maintaining regional peace and security and avoiding conflicts. The ASEAN Regional Forum (1994) works for security dialogue. ASEAN follows non-interference in internal matters and the Treaty of Amity and Cooperation (1976).

2. ASEAN Economic Community (AEC):

It aims at a single market and production base, free flow of goods, services and investment, and reducing the development gap among members. The ASEAN Free Trade Area (AFTA) was created for this. ASEAN has also made trade agreements with China, India, Japan and South Korea.

3. ASEAN Socio-Cultural Community (ASCC):

It aims at cooperation in education, culture, health, environment and social development, to build a common ASEAN identity and improve people's lives.

These three pillars make ASEAN one of the most successful regional organisations of Asia, and India has a 'Look/Act East' policy relation with it.

Q.4(c) Discuss China's role in world politics.

Ans:

China is the world's most populous country and the second-largest economy; it is a nuclear power and a permanent member of the UN Security Council with veto power.

- Economic role: after the 1978 reforms (Open Door Policy of Deng Xiaoping), China grew very fast and became the 'factory of the world'. It is a major trading partner and investor across Asia, Africa and Latin America.
- Belt and Road Initiative (BRI): a big infrastructure and trade project to connect Asia, Africa and Europe, increasing China's global influence.
- Political role: it has emerged as a challenger to US dominance, promoting a multipolar world; it plays an important role in the UN, BRICS, SCO and the AIIB.
- Military role: it has a large army and is modernising its navy, and has disputes in the South China Sea, Taiwan and with India on the border.
- Regional role: it plays a key role in East Asia and in the ASEAN region.

Thus, China has become a rising superpower and its role is very important in contemporary world politics.

PART – B : Politics in India Since Independence

Q.5 Answer any six (1 mark each)

(a) Name a major project included in the First Five Year Plan.

Ans: Bhakra-Nangal Dam project (also Hirakud and Damodar Valley).

(b) In which year did the era of coalition government start in the Centre?

Ans: 1989.

(c) Which institution has replaced the Planning Commission of India?

Ans: NITI Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India), 2015.

(d) Which party led the National Democratic Alliance?

Ans: Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).

(e) Under which government was the Mandal Commission appointed?

Ans: Janata Party government headed by Morarji Desai (1979).

(f) In which year was Nagaland state created?

Ans: 1963.

(g) Simla Agreement was signed between India and ____.

Ans: Pakistan.

(h) In which year was internal emergency declared for the first time in India?

Ans: 1975 (25 June 1975).

(i) In which year was the State Reorganisation Commission formed?

Ans: 1953.

(j) Agreement signed between Lal Bahadur Shastri and General Ayub Khan in 1966?

Ans: Tashkent Agreement (Tashkent Declaration).

Q.6 Answer any five (2 marks each)

Q.6(a) Write a short note on 'Privy Purses'.

Ans:

Privy Purses were fixed annual payments given by the Government of India to the former princes and rulers of the princely states after their merger with India, in return for giving up their states and powers. This was criticised as being against equality, and was abolished by the 26th Constitutional Amendment in 1971 under Indira Gandhi's government.

Q.6(b) Mention two causes for the rise of communalism.

Ans:

- Divide and rule policy of the British, and the Partition of India in 1947.
- Use of religion for political gain by politicians and parties (vote-bank politics), along with poverty, unemployment and illiteracy.

Q.6(c) What is 'Grand Alliance' in the context of Indian politics?

Ans:

The Grand Alliance was an electoral alliance formed in the 1971 Lok Sabha election by the opposition parties like Congress (O), Swatantra Party, Jana Sangh and the Socialist parties against Indira Gandhi. Its slogan was 'Indira Hatao', while Indira Gandhi replied with 'Garibi Hatao' and won the election.

Q.6(d) Write two features of New Economic Policy.

Ans:

The New Economic Policy of 1991 had these features:

- Liberalisation: removal of licence–permit raj and controls on industries and trade.
- Privatisation and globalisation: reducing government role in industries, welcoming foreign investment and MNCs.

Q.6(e) When was the Election Commission of India formed? Who was the first Chief Election Commissioner?

Ans:

The Election Commission of India was formed on 25 January 1950. The first Chief Election Commissioner was Sukumar Sen.

[OR] Q.6(e) Mention any two ideologies of Bharatiya Jana Sangha.

Ans:

The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was founded in 1951 by Syama Prasad Mukherjee. Two ideologies:

- 'One country, one culture, one nation' (Akhand Bharat) with emphasis on Hindu cultural nationalism (Hindutva).
- Opposition to special status of Jammu and Kashmir, demand for a uniform civil code and ban on cow slaughter.

Q.6(f) Mention two solutions of the problem of regionalism.

Ans:

- Balanced economic development of all regions and equal sharing of resources, so that no region feels neglected.
- Strengthening true federalism by giving more powers to states, developing national integration and a spirit of unity in diversity.

[OR] Q.6(f) Write two causes of the emergence of regionalism.

Ans:

- Differences of language, culture, religion and tribe among regions.
- Regional economic imbalance and neglect of some regions by the Centre, creating a feeling of deprivation.

Q.7 Answer any three (4 marks each)

Q.7(a) Discuss the role of opposition party in India.

Ans:

In a parliamentary democracy, the opposition has a very important role. Its main roles are:

- To criticise the wrong policies of the government and keep a check on its power, so that the government does not become autocratic.
- To raise public problems in Parliament through questions, debates, adjournment motions and no-confidence motions.
- To act as an alternative government; the leader of the opposition has a special status in India.
- To play a part in committees (like the Public Accounts Committee) and to make people aware of government work.

Thus, a strong opposition is essential for the success of democracy.

Q.7(b) Why did the leaders of Freedom Movement give importance to the principle of secularism?

Ans:

India is a land of many religions, castes and cultures. The leaders of the freedom movement like Gandhi, Nehru, Maulana Azad and Ambedkar gave importance to secularism because:

- To maintain national unity and keep all religious communities together against British rule.
- The British followed divide and rule, and the Muslim League's demand for separate Pakistan showed the danger of communalism.
- They wanted equality and religious freedom for all citizens; the state should treat all religions equally and have no state religion.
- The tragic experience of Partition and communal riots strengthened this belief. Hence secularism became a basic feature of the Indian Constitution.

[OR] Q.7(b) Explain the consequences of partition of India.

Ans:

The Partition of 1947 created India and Pakistan and had many serious consequences:

- Massive communal violence in which lakhs of people were killed, especially in Punjab and Bengal.
- Mass migration: about 80 lakh people crossed the border, creating a serious refugee problem and the need for rehabilitation.
- Division of resources, army, assets and administration, and economic loss (jute, tea, railways).
- Kashmir problem and permanent hostility between India and Pakistan; communal tension within India.
- Partition of Punjab and Bengal, and Assam's Sylhet district went to East Pakistan (a referendum was held), which also affected Karimganj area.

Q.7(c) Discuss the causes of the defeat of Congress in 1977.

Ans:

In the 1977 Lok Sabha election, Congress lost power at the Centre for the first time, and the Janata Party won. Causes:

- The Emergency (1975–77): suspension of civil liberties, press censorship, and arrest of opposition leaders.
- Forced sterilisation campaign (family planning), slum demolitions and excesses of Sanjay Gandhi and officials.
- Unity of the opposition: parties merged to form the Janata Party under Jayaprakash Narayan's leadership ('Total Revolution').
- Inflation, unemployment, corruption and growing public anger against Indira Gandhi's authoritarian rule; Congress lost badly in North India.

Q.7(d) Explain briefly the dominance of Congress Party in the first three general elections.

Ans:

Congress won the elections of 1952, 1957 and 1962 with large majorities, because:

- Its legacy of leading the freedom struggle and its popular leaders like Nehru, Patel and Azad.
- It was a broad 'rainbow' party with a strong nationwide organisation, representing all classes, castes and religions.
- The opposition was weak, divided and scattered; the first-past-the-post (FPTP) system helped the largest party win more seats than its vote share.

- Nehru's charismatic leadership. This is called the 'Congress System' (Rajni Kothari).

[OR] Q.7(d) Explain the challenges that India faced after independence.

Ans:

After independence in 1947, India faced three major challenges:

- Nation building: to build a united nation out of diverse languages, religions and regions, and integration of 500+ princely states and partition's refugees.
- Establishing democracy: to adopt a democratic constitution, hold free elections and ensure rights of all people.
- Economic development and welfare: to remove poverty, backwardness and inequality through planning and equal opportunity.

Besides, problems of language, reorganisation of states, Kashmir and the issue of foreign policy also arose.

Q.7(e) What were the British Indian states? How did they differ from Princely states?

Ans:

British Indian provinces were the territories directly ruled by the British government through its Governors and officials. Princely states were ruled by Indian princes under British paramountcy.

Differences:

- British Indian provinces were under direct British administration; princely states had internal autonomy under their rulers, though defence and foreign affairs were controlled by the British.
- Provinces had British laws and civil services; princely states had hereditary monarchs. Princely states were about 565 in number and were later integrated into India (by Sardar Patel and V.P. Menon) through the Instrument of Accession.

[OR] Q.7(e) What are the main principles of India's foreign policy?

Ans:

The main principles are:

- Non-alignment: keeping away from the military blocs of the Cold War (Nehru).
- Panchsheel (five principles of peaceful coexistence, 1954) and opposition to colonialism, imperialism and racism.
- Peaceful settlement of disputes and promotion of world peace and disarmament; support for the United Nations.
- Safeguarding national interest, sovereignty and security; cooperation with the Third World countries; 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam'.

Q.8 Answer any two (6 marks each)

Q.8(a) Discuss the main controversies around planned development in the early years of India's independence.

Ans:

After independence, India adopted planning (Planning Commission 1950, First Five Year Plan 1951). But there were many debates and controversies on the path of development:

- Agriculture vs industry: The First Plan stressed agriculture, but the Second Plan (Mahalanobis model, 1956) gave priority to heavy industry. Critics said agriculture was neglected and food shortages increased.
- Public vs private sector: Nehru favoured a mixed economy with a strong public sector; the Bombay Plan industrialists and the Swatantra Party wanted more private enterprise and less state control.

- Large vs small/cottage industries: Gandhians wanted village and small industries, while others stressed large industries for rapid growth.
- Centralised planning vs states' rights: states complained about Centre's dominance in planning and resources.
- Land reforms and inequality: abolition of zamindari was partially implemented; benefits to the poor were limited. Critics argued planning ignored human development, education and health.
- Foreign dependence: debates on foreign aid and technology versus self-reliance.

Despite these controversies, planning laid the foundation of India's industrial base and self-reliance.

Q.8(b) Discuss India's relation with neighbouring countries.

Ans:

India has seven land neighbours: Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Sri Lanka (sea), Afghanistan, Maldives. Its policy is 'Neighbourhood First'.

- Pakistan: strained relations due to Kashmir, wars (1947, 1965, 1971, 1999) and terrorism; peace efforts include Tashkent, Simla and Lahore.
- China: 1954 Panchsheel, but the 1962 war and border disputes (Arunachal, Aksai Chin, Galwan clash 2020); yet trade is large.
- Bangladesh: India helped in its creation in 1971; Farakka Treaty 1996 and Land Boundary Agreement 2015; issues of illegal migration, Teesta water, border security. This is very important for Assam/Karimganj.
- Nepal and Bhutan: friendly; Indo-Nepal Treaty of Peace and Friendship 1950 and Indo-Bhutan Treaty; cultural and economic ties, open border with Nepal.
- Sri Lanka: cultural ties; the Tamil issue and IPKF intervention (1987–90), fishermen disputes.
- Myanmar, Afghanistan, Maldives: cooperation in connectivity (Kaladan Project), development aid and security.

India follows the principles of peace, mutual respect and cooperation, and is a member of SAARC and BIMSTEC.

Q.8(c) Discuss the principles and challenges associated with the partition of the country.

Ans:

The Partition of 1947 was based on the Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947) and the Indian Independence Act 1947.

Principles:

- Religion-based division: Muslim-majority areas to go to Pakistan and the rest to India, mainly in the north-west and east of the subcontinent.
- The principle of contiguous majority areas, and for provinces like Punjab and Bengal, they were to be divided on district/tehsil basis. A referendum was held in NWFP and Sylhet (Assam).
- Princely states were free to join either dominion, depending on geography and people's wish.

Challenges:

- Many areas had mixed populations, so a clear religion-based division was impossible; Muslims remained in India and Hindus/Sikhs in Pakistan, creating minority problems.
- Boundary line (Radcliffe Line) was drawn in haste, leading to violence and killing; mass migration created refugee crises.
- Partition of resources, army and administration, rehabilitation of lakhs of refugees, and the problem of Kashmir, Junagadh and Hyderabad.

- Restoring communal harmony and the safety of women and children, who suffered abduction and violence.

[OR] Q.8(c) What is planning? What are its role on 'Development'?

Ans:

Planning means the process of deciding in advance the goals, resources and methods to be used to achieve economic and social development within a fixed period. In India, the Planning Commission was set up in 1950 (replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015), and Five Year Plans were followed.

Role of planning in development:

- Proper use of resources: it ensures that limited natural, human and financial resources are used properly for national priorities.
- Economic growth: development of agriculture (Green Revolution), industry (steel plants, heavy industry), power, irrigation and transport.
- Removal of poverty and unemployment and reduction of regional and income inequalities.
- Self-reliance and welfare: reducing dependence on foreign countries and improving education, health and living standards (social justice).
- Balanced regional development and building of infrastructure like dams (Bhakra-Nangal), roads and railways.

Thus, planning has played an important role in India's development, though not all its aims were fully achieved.

PART – C : For Old Course Students (in lieu of Project Works)

Q.9 Answer any two (5 marks each)

Q.9(a) Briefly describe the goals of New International Economic Order (NIEO).

Ans:

The NIEO was a demand of the developing (Third World) countries, put forward at UNCTAD in 1972 and supported by the Non-Aligned Movement, to reform the unequal international economic system. Its main goals were:

- Control over natural resources: developing countries should have full control over their own natural resources.
- Access to Western markets: to sell their goods and get fairer trade terms and prices for raw materials.
- Reduction of the cost of Western technology and more technology transfer.
- Greater role in international economic institutions like the IMF and World Bank, and reduction of debt burdens.

However, the developed countries did not fully accept it, and it could not be fully achieved.

[OR] Q.9(a) Write briefly about Non-Aligned Movement (NAM).

Ans:

NAM was a movement of newly independent countries to stay away from the military blocs of the USA and USSR in the Cold War. It was founded in 1961 at the Belgrade Summit by Jawaharlal Nehru (India), Tito (Yugoslavia), Nasser (Egypt), Sukarno (Indonesia) and Nkrumah (Ghana); its basis was the Bandung Conference of 1955.

- Aims: to protect independence and sovereignty, oppose colonialism and imperialism, promote peace, disarmament and a fair economic order.
- It gave small countries an independent voice and role, and supported NIEO. It had 120 member states by now. After the Cold War, its relevance is debated but it still works for developing country interests.

Q.9(b) What are the different types of hegemony? Give example of each of them.

Ans:

Hegemony means the dominance or leadership of one country over others. The types are:

- Hegemony as hard power (military): based on military strength; example: the USA with its huge military, weapons and bases around the world, e.g., the Iraq war of 2003.
- Structural power (economic): control over the global economy and institutions; example: the USA's role in Bretton Woods institutions (IMF, World Bank, WTO) and use of the dollar as global currency.
- Soft power (ideological and cultural): ability to shape people's preferences through culture, ideas and media; example: Hollywood films, American lifestyle, universities and consumer brands, and the spread of English and values like liberty.

Q.9(c) Discuss briefly the consequences of Globalisation.

Ans:

Globalisation has affected economic, political and cultural life.

Economic consequences:

- Increase in world trade, foreign investment and growth of MNCs; but it increased inequality and caused job loss in some sectors.

Political consequences:

- Reduced the power and sovereignty of the state, while the role of international bodies like WTO and non-state actors has increased; but the state remains important.

Cultural consequences:

- Spread of a common (mostly Western) culture, 'McDonaldisation'; threats to local cultures; but also cultural exchange and hybrid cultures.

Thus globalisation has both benefits and costs; countries must manage it carefully.

[OR] Q.9(c) Do you think that UNO is a perfect international organisation? Give reasons.**Ans:**

No, the UNO is not a perfect organisation, although it has done many good works like peacekeeping, humanitarian aid, and the work of agencies such as WHO, UNICEF and UNESCO. The reasons are:

- Domination of the big powers: the five permanent members of the Security Council hold veto power, and use it for their own interests.
- Security Council is outdated: it does not represent the present world (no permanent seat for India, Africa or Latin America); reforms are delayed.
- It lacks its own army and depends on member states; it failed in cases like Rwanda, Iraq (2003) and Ukraine.
- Financial dependence on rich countries, mainly the USA, and inequality between member states.

So the UN needs reforms to become more democratic and effective.

Q.10 Answer any two (5 marks each)**Q.10(a) Why did the Narmada Bachao Andolan oppose the dam project in the Narmada valley?****Ans:**

The Narmada Bachao Andolan (NBA), led by Medha Patkar, Baba Amte and others, opposed the Sardar Sarovar Dam and other dams on the Narmada river for these reasons:

- Displacement: lakhs of people, mostly tribals (adivasis) and farmers, would lose their homes and land due to submergence of villages.
- Poor rehabilitation: the government gave inadequate compensation, land and resettlement to the affected people.
- Environmental damage: loss of forests, wildlife, fertile land and the river ecosystem.
- Benefit-cost issue: critics said the benefits of water and electricity would go to rich people and cities, while the poor bore the costs; they preferred smaller local projects.

The movement used non-violent protests, rallies and legal petitions, and it became a model for people's movements in India.

Q.10(b) What is Hung Parliament? Discuss the current political situations of India and frequent cases of Hung Parliament.**Ans:**

A Hung Parliament is a situation in which no single party or pre-poll alliance gets a clear majority (272 out of 543 in Lok Sabha) in an election. The result is a coalition or minority government.

Cases in India:

- Since 1989, there were many hung Parliaments: 1989 (V.P. Singh's National Front), 1991, 1996, 1998, 1999 and 2004 and 2009 (coalitions like the NDA and UPA).

- Short-lived governments such as those of Chandra Shekhar, Deve Gowda and I.K. Gujral and A.B. Vajpayee's 13-day government (1996) show instability.
- Causes: rise of regional parties, decline of Congress dominance, caste and religious politics, multi-party system, and the FPTP election system.

Present situation:

- BJP won a clear majority in 2014 and 2019, but in the 2024 election it fell short of an absolute majority on its own (240 seats) and formed the government with NDA allies, so coalition politics has returned.

Hung Parliaments cause instability, horse-trading and defections, but also make government more consultative.

[OR] Q.10(b) Discuss the importance of regional parties in coalition government.

Ans:

Since 1989, regional parties have become very important in coalition politics, e.g., DMK, AIADMK, TDP, Akali Dal, Shiv Sena, Trinamool Congress, AGP, BJD and JD(U).

- Support for government formation: national parties need their support to get a majority; they have bargaining power and enjoy ministerial posts.
- Representation of local interests: they bring regional demands, language and cultural issues, and development needs to the national level.
- Strengthening federalism: they have increased the voice of states and reduced the Centre's dominance.
- Dual role: they sometimes cause instability by withdrawing support (e.g., 1999), and may make regional demands over national interest. Still, they have made politics more representative and democratic.

Q.10(c) Explain briefly the politics and programme of Bharatiya Janata Party.

Ans:

The BJP was formed in 1980, successor to the Bharatiya Jana Sangh, with A.B. Vajpayee as its first president. It has been in power at the Centre in 1996, 1998–2004 and since 2014.

Politics (ideology):

- Cultural nationalism (Hindutva) and integral humanism of Deendayal Upadhyaya; emphasis on a strong nation and national security.
- Opposition to what it calls 'pseudo-secularism' or appeasement of minorities; support for a Uniform Civil Code.

Programme:

- Abrogation of Article 370 (done in 2019), building the Ram Mandir at Ayodhya (completed 2024), and Uniform Civil Code.
- Economic liberalisation with a stress on self-reliance (Atmanirbhar Bharat), infrastructure development, digital India and welfare schemes.
- Strong foreign policy and defence.